FROM ONE HIT TO ANOTHER

Cricketer **Shikhar Dhawan,** the man Team India looks to when it needs a senior player to stand in as captain, will soon be seen on the big screen, playing a cameo role in the film *Double XL*

Q. How much do you enjoy captaincy? And is there any pressure that comes with it?
I have always enjoyed captaincy. It gives me an opportunity to connect with the boys and pass on my experience. There is, of course, the pressure—you must manage multiple things at the same time—but rather than getting worked up, I enjoy it. I like to stay calm because that is what rubs off on to the team. I make it a point that through my actions on and off the pitch, we look at the brighter side and stay motivated.

Q. Earlier this month, you said you want to play the 2023 ODI World Cup...
Yes, I want to see myself playing the 2023 World Cup, but I am not putting pressure on myself. For me, the most important thing is to enjoy the journey. Winning the World Cup is every cricketer's dream, but to be honest, I don't only want to be a part of a World Cup-winning squad, I want to win it for the country.

Q. You are about to make your Bollywood debut. What did you enjoy the most when shooting for *Double XL*?
It has been an exciting experience. When this opportunity came my way, I was really appreciative of the story and script. I have done multiple shoots for brands and events, so I wasn't worried about being in front of the camera. I am thankful to Huma [Qureshi] for making me feel comfortable. I enjoyed working with her.

Q. You are extremely creative with your social media content. What is it that you think of while making those reels?
I am a light-hearted and fun-loving person; so the moment I feel there is a reel that suits my personality and mind-space, I go and create it. People now get to know and love me on and off the pitch. It is extremely heartening.

with Shail Desai

